GBC

| Psychology Teaching |



Psychology made understandable, relevant and useful

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Psychology provides valuable ways of understanding how people think, feel, behave, develop, relate to others and respond to the situations and environments around them.

My teaching brings psychological theory and research into an accessible and engaging learning environment, with a strong emphasis on understanding concepts and connecting them to real-life situations.

Courses, workshops and individual teaching can be developed for schools and training institutions, organisations, professional groups and individual learners, with the content, depth and teaching methods adapted to the audience and their learning objectives.

What can I teach?

My teaching covers a broad range of psychological subjects, including:

- **Foundations of psychology** – major psychological perspectives and different approaches to understanding human behaviour.
- **Psychodynamic & psychoanalytic perspectives** – Freud, unconscious processes, defence mechanisms, early experiences and recurring patterns of behaviour.
- **Humanistic psychology** – Rogers, Maslow, self-concept, congruence, values, meaning and human potential.
- **Behavioural psychology** – classical and operant conditioning, reinforcement, observational learning, learned behaviour and behaviour change.
- **Cognitive psychology & CBT principles** – automatic thoughts, cognitive biases and distortions, and interactions between thoughts, emotions and behaviour.
- **Systemic psychology** – understanding individuals within families, relationships, groups, workplaces and wider social systems.
- **Attachment & relationships** – attachment patterns, interpersonal relationships and their influence on behaviour and wellbeing.
- **Human development** – psychological development across the lifespan, including Erikson's psychosocial perspective.
- **Identity** – personal, narrative and social identity and the influence of experiences, relationships, groups and culture on our sense of self.
- **Personality & individual differences** – including the Big Five/OCEAN model and differences in how people experience and respond to the world.
- **Emotions & feelings** – emotional processes, emotional awareness and relationships between emotions, thoughts and behaviour.
- **Motivation** – intrinsic and extrinsic motivation, autonomy, competence, meaning, values and individual motivational differences.
- **Subjective wellbeing** – life satisfaction, positive and negative affect and psychological influences on wellbeing.

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- **Stress psychology** – psychological, biological and social influences on stress, perception and appraisal, the autonomic nervous system, chronic stress, recovery, sleep and workplace stress.
- **The biopsychosocial perspective** – exploring health and wellbeing through the interaction of biological, psychological and social factors.
- **Anxiety** – anxiety, worry and fear, cognitive processes, avoidance, safety behaviours and behavioural patterns associated with anxiety.
- **Depression** – psychological perspectives on depression, cognition, withdrawal, motivation, activity and behavioural activation.
- **Borderline personality disorder** – emotional dysregulation, impulsivity and interpersonal difficulties, together with an introduction to relevant psychological approaches.
- **Suicide & psychological crisis** – risk and protective factors, warning signs, appropriate professional responses, boundaries and referral.
- **Behaviour change & habits** – how behaviours are learned and maintained and the psychological factors involved in changing them.
- **Communication & helping relationships** – listening, questioning, empathy, communication and understanding people within their wider context.
- **Psychotherapeutic approaches** – understanding and comparing psychoanalytic, humanistic, behavioural, cognitive and systemic perspectives.
- **Psychology in professional practice** – applying psychological concepts to case studies, developing critical thinking and understanding professional roles and boundaries.

These areas reflect the breadth of the psychology teaching developed across my existing courses, from fundamental psychological theories and systemic, behavioural and humanistic perspectives through identity, motivation and subjective wellbeing to anxiety, depression, stress and suicide.

From knowledge to understanding

My teaching follows a simple learning process: Understand → Reflect → Apply

Psychological theory is combined with case studies, real-world examples, discussion, guided reflection and practical exercises.

Learners are encouraged to explore different psychological perspectives, ask questions, think critically about the evidence and apply concepts to realistic situations. This creates learning that can be understood, discussed and transferred beyond the classroom.

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Teaching adapted to your needs

For schools and training institutions, I can provide individual modules, specialist psychology teaching or structured courses designed around existing curricula and learning objectives.

For organisations and professional groups, teaching can focus on areas such as human behaviour, motivation, communication, relationships, workplace psychology, stress, wellbeing and the psychological dimensions of professional practice.

For individual learners and groups, sessions can be developed around particular areas of psychology for professional development, further learning or personal interest.

The format can range from a single focused session or workshop to a structured series of courses, depending on the subject, audience and required depth.

My approach

I hold an MSc in Psychology and an FSEA qualification in adult education, combining academic psychology with practical experience teaching psychology and wellbeing to adult learners.

My approach follows the principles of effective adult learning: clear learning objectives, structured content, accessible theory, active participation, critical reflection and practical application.

Content is adapted to participants' existing knowledge, professional context and learning objectives, allowing complex psychological ideas to be explored at an appropriate and useful level.

The core idea

Psychology becomes most valuable when understanding develops into something we can recognise, question and apply to real life.

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